

Skill Up! Mainframe Learning For All

2025 SHARE Conference - Cleveland, OH

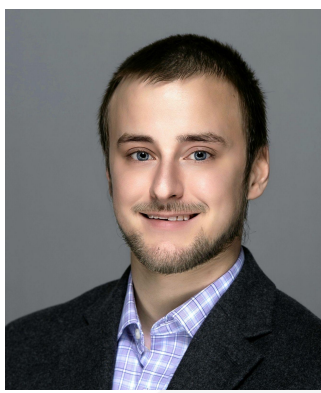


MEET THE SKILL UP TEAM!



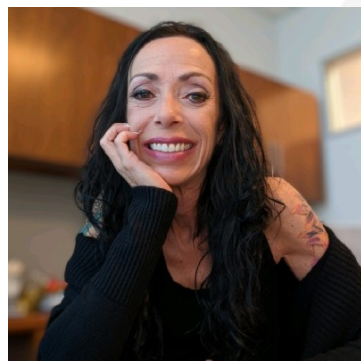
**Devonte' Hawkins – Z Data and AI Technical Specialist,
IBM**

**Joe Winchester - Senior Technical Staff Member, Zowe
Open Mainframe Project Ambassador - Master Inventor,
IBM**



Hunter Johnson – Product Marketing Engineer, Broadcom

**Michael Bauer – OMP Ambassador & IBM Champion
Engineering Manager, Broadcom**



**Donna Hudi - Chief Marketing Officer & Head of Business
Development, Phoenix Software**



OPEN MAINFRAME PROJECT RESOURCES

Introduction

As the mainframe industry continues to evolve, the demand for learning that is both accessible and engaging has never been greater. This session brings together leaders from the Open Mainframe Project (OMP) Education Initiative, the COBOL Programming Course, and Zowe to explore the future of mainframe education. The discussion will showcase key resources—including the OMP Education GitBook, COBOL Programming with VS Code, and the Fundamentals for Zowe course—that are helping professionals at every stage of their journey. Join us for an inspiring conversation on how these tools are shaping the next generation of mainframe talent.

What is the Open Mainframe Project?

The Open Mainframe Project (OMP) is a collaborative initiative hosted by the Linux Foundation, created to drive innovation and growth in the mainframe ecosystem through open source. Its mission is to make mainframe technology more accessible, modern, and sustainable by building a strong community of developers, students, and enterprises.



Driving Innovation, Education, and Community

OMP supports dozens of open-source projects—such as Zowe, GenevaERS, COBOL Programming Course, and Feilong—that bring modern tools, languages, and frameworks to the mainframe. In addition, the project fosters education and workforce development through programs like mentorships, scholarships, and the OMP Education Initiative. By connecting industry leaders, academic institutions, and open-source contributors, the Open Mainframe Project ensures that the platform remains vital and innovative for decades to come.

Mainframe Open Education Gitbook

Current Content Structure:

- Welcome: Learn & Contribute to MOE
- Chapter 1: What is a Mainframe Today?
- Chapter 2: Foundational Technology
- Chapter 3: Roles in Mainframe
- Chapter 4: Deeper Dive in Role Chosen
- Chapter 5: Career Path Opportunities
- Backlog topics

Future topics and suggestions:

- My Mainframe Journey: From Students to Professionals
- Additional Community Resources
- Digital Certificate Badges
- z/OS Mainframe Practitioner
- Reviewer List

You can help us with:

- Join MOE: Sign up and log in now!
- Usability testing: How can we make MOE more accessible?
- Content critique: Does the content helpful to you?
- Content suggestion: Content you would like to see here
- Content development: How can we develop the content into a curriculum for university learners like you
- Content contribution: Contribute and learn
- Claim a badge: Showcase your contribution on social media



Zowe is a new open-source software framework that provides solutions that allow development and operations teams to securely, manage, control, script and develop on the Mainframe like any other cloud platform. Zowe is the first open-source project based on z/OS.

Resources:

- <https://openmainframeproject.org/projects/zowe/>
- **Community Page:** <https://www.zowe.org/>
- **GitHub:** <https://github.com/zowe>



COBOL Programming Course with VSCode

Mission

- Attract next generation of learners to add COBOL to their tech toolkit
- Provide an improved learning experience (modern tool interface)
- Create and engage with an enthusiastic community of learners

Benefits

- Leverage modern tooling (VS Code, Zowe) to enhance the learning experience
- Gain valuable experience through **hands-on labs**
- A key differentiator on your professional profile – an in-demand skill set



OPEN **MAINFRAME** PROJECT
COBOL
Programming Course

Open Mainframe Mentorship

- 2021 - **Hartanto Ario Widjaya** added new chapters to the course including topics like compilation, ABEND handling, and copybooks.
Ahmed Eid update course images to stay current with recent Zowe Explorer enhancements.
- 2022 - **Sri Sai Natha Rao Pathange** updated our course content to leverage Zowe V2 LTS.
2023 - **Ashish Kumar** added a section on unit testing COBOL programs using COBOL Check.
- 2024 - **Rituraj Mahato** updated our course content to leverage Zowe V3 LTS.
Ali Mohamed developed content to exercise COBOL Check from GitHub Actions.
- 2025 - **Athar Ramzan** is developing additional, more thought-provoking lab exercises to reinforce the education content.

Check out our project at <https://github.com/openmainframeproject/cobol-programming-course>



THANK YOU!

Your feedback is important!

Submit a session evaluation for each session you attend:

www.share.org/evaluation

